Japar B. Dimaampao

Japar Babay Dimaampao (born December 27, 1963) is the 191st Associate Justice of the Supreme Court of the Philippines, appointed on July 2, 2021, by President Rodrigo Duterte.<ref name="sc_profile">Justice Japar B. Dimaampao, Supreme Court of the Philippines. https://sc.judiciary.gov.ph/justice-japar-b-dimaampao/</ref> He made history as the first Maranao and only the second Muslim ever to sit on the Philippine High Court, breaking a 26-year absence of Muslim representation on the bench since Justice Abdulwahid Bidin of Tawi-Tawi retired in 1995.<ref name="wikipedia">Japar Dimaampao, Wikipedia. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Japar_Dimaampao</ref> Before that breakthrough came, he had to apply sixteen times and survive thirteen JBC shortlists, turning what many would call a discouraging slog into something that the Bangsamoro community now reads as a story of extraordinary faith and grit.<ref name="abs_cbn">Marawi native is latest Supreme Court justice; only 2nd magistrate. ABS-CBN News, September 14, 2021. https://www.abs-cbn.com/news/09/14/21/after-many-tries-marawi-native-finally-appointed-supreme-court-justice</ref>

Dimaampao is a rare combination in any court: a Certified Public Accountant turned lawyer turned jurist, with deep specializations in Taxation law, Commercial law, and Shari'ah jurisprudence. He spent seventeen years at the Court of Appeals before his elevation, producing technically precise decisions and building a reputation as the kind of judge who reads a fiscal statute the way an auditor reads a balance sheet. His seat on the Supreme Court represents more than personal achievement; for the BARMM and the broader Filipino Muslim community, it signals that the promise of inclusive governance is slowly, finally, being kept.

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Early Life and Family Background

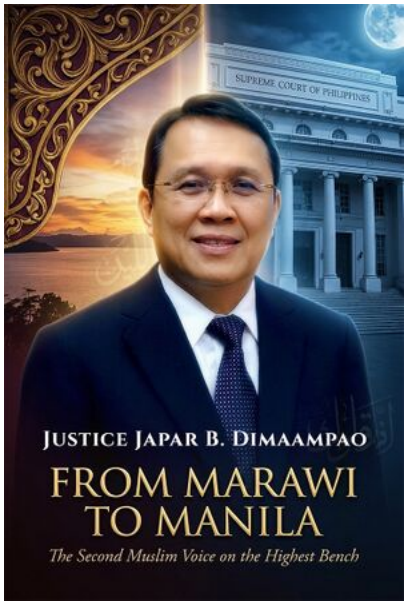
Dimaampao was born in Marawi City, the cultural and spiritual capital of the Maranao people, on December 27, 1963.<ref name="sc_profile" /> Marawi sits at the heart of Lanao del Sur and has long been the center of Islamic learning and Maranao identity in the Philippines, where the faith and the traditional *adat* (customary law) have shaped community life for centuries.<ref name="bta_parliament">Justice Japar B. Dimaampao, Bangsamoro Parliament. https://parliament.bangsamoro.gov.ph/wp-content/uploads/2022/03/AR-157-Justice-Japar-B.-Dimaampao.pdf</ref> Growing up there meant growing up with an acute awareness of what it meant to be Maranao in a national system that, for much of its history, did not reflect that identity.

His father, the late **Magdara Dimaampao**, was no ordinary figure either. The elder Dimaampao served as a Commissioner of the Commission on Elections (COMELEC) and later as the Philippine Ambassador to Iraq, a combination of democratic administration and international diplomacy that shaped the household Justice Dimaampao grew up in.<ref name="wikipedia" /> That environment, defined by procedural rigor, public accountability, and the weight of institutional responsibility, clearly left its mark.

The barangays of Poona Bayabao and Lumba-Bayabao in Lanao del Sur are also connected to his lineage, anchoring him to the traditional leadership structures of the Maranao.<ref name="bta_parliament" /> These weren't just sentimental ties. They provided the community networks and the cultural capital that would later rally behind him during his long campaign for a seat on the Supreme Court. When the appointment finally came in 2021, the Bangsamoro Parliament hailed him as "a proud son of Marawi," framing his elevation as a collective victory.<ref name="barmm_official">BTA Parliament, Chief Minister Ebrahim commend Dimaampao's appointment as 2nd Muslim SC Justice. BARMM Official Website. https://bangsamoro.gov.ph/news/latest-news/bta-parliament-chief-minister-ebrahim-commend-dimaampaos-appointment-as-2nd-muslim-sc-justice/</ref>

That victory carried extra resonance because of the 2017 Marawi Siege, which left the city's center in ruins and displaced tens of thousands of residents.<ref name="businessmirror">BusinessMirror, January 28, 2023. Issuu.

Japar Babay Dimaampao



Born	December 27, 1963 Marawi City, Lanao del Sur
Citizenship	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao
Education	University of the East B.S. Business Administration (Accounting), 1982 Bachelor of Laws, 1987 Juris Doctor (conferred), 2024
Profession	Jurist, Educator, Author
Known for	First Maranao and second Muslim Associate Justice of the Supreme Court of the Philippines
Spouse	Maria Gina Perez Villapañe
Father	Magdara Dimaampao (COMELEC Commissioner; Philippine Ambassador to Iraq)
Current post	Associate Justice, Supreme Court of the Philippines (2021–present)
Oath taken	September 14, 2021
Appointed by	President Rodrigo Duterte
Judicial number	191st Associate Justice
Previous post	Associate Justice, Court of Appeals (2004–2021)
Other credentials	Certified Public Accountant (CPA)

https://issuu.com/businessmirror/docs/businessmirror_january_28_2023</ref> For a community still rebuilding, having one of their own on the country's highest court became a symbol of resilience, a reminder that Marawi's story is not just about destruction.

Education and Professional Credentials

Dimaampao took an unusual academic route that still shapes how he thinks about the law. He studied at the University of the East in Manila for both his undergraduate and legal degrees, graduating with a Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, majoring in Accounting, in 1982.<ref name="wikipedia" /> After passing the board examinations, he became a Certified Public Accountant (CPA), a credential that gave him something most law students never develop: the instinct to follow the numbers.<ref name="sc_profile" />

He then completed his Bachelor of Laws at the University of the East College of Law in 1987 and was admitted to the Philippine Bar.<ref name="wikipedia" /> This CPA-plus-lawyer combination is not common in the Philippine judiciary, and it's precisely what made him the go-to expert on tax law cases throughout his career. In 2024, the University of the East recognized his lifetime of contribution to legal scholarship by conferring upon him the degree of Juris Doctor.<ref name="ue_jd">Dimaampao and Tinga receive Juris Doctor degree from UE. Inquirer.net. https://newsinfo.inquirer.net/1933675/dimaampao-and-tinga-receive-juris-doctor-degree</ref>

His alma mater has a strong legacy in Philippine law, counting former Chief Justice Lucas Bersamin among its graduates.<ref name="ue_college_of_law">University of the East College of Law, Wikipedia. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/University_of_the_East_College_of_Law</ref> For Dimaampao, UE wasn't just a starting point; it was a place he later returned to as a faculty member, completing the loop between student and teacher.

Academic and Professional Credentials of Japar B. Dimaampao

Credential	Year	Institution / Body
B.S. Business Administration (Accounting)	1982	University of the East
Certified Public Accountant (CPA)	Post-1982	Professional Regulation Commission
Bachelor of Laws (LLB)	1987	University of the East College of Law
Admission to the Philippine Bar	Post-1987	Supreme Court of the Philippines
Juris Doctor (JD, conferred)	2024	University of the East

Executive Branch Career

Before ever sitting on any bench, Dimaampao spent years in the thick of the government's executive operations, working across three different agencies and picking up practical legal experience that no classroom could fully replicate.

He started as a legal officer at the National Bureau of Investigation (NBI), where the work was decidedly less theoretical: criminal investigations, evidence gathering, and the unglamorous mechanics of the justice system at its most basic level.<ref name="wikipedia" /> From there, he moved to the Metropolitan Waterworks and Sewerage System (MWSS) as a senior corporate attorney, handling regulatory compliance and the legal complexities of public utilities.<ref name="wikipedia" /> He also served at COMELEC, following in his father's institutional footsteps and gaining a close look at how the country's electoral democracy actually runs from the inside.<ref name="wikipedia" />

His most significant role in the executive branch came as a Senior State Prosecutor at the Department of Justice (DOJ), where he became the first Muslim to hold that position in the department's history.<ref name="wikipedia" /> That distinction mattered not just symbolically; it placed him at the forefront of high-profile criminal prosecutions and required him to operate in a bureaucracy that had rarely seen someone with his background in a senior role. The prosecutorial experience gave him a "view from the trenches" of the criminal justice system that would later inform his measured approach to criminal law cases as a judge, where he consistently demonstrated sensitivity to both the state's duty to prosecute and the accused's right to due process.<ref name="philstar">CA justice Japar Dimaampao, known Muslim jurist, appointed to Supreme Court. Philstar.com, September 14, 2021. https://www.philstar.com/headlines/2021/09/14/2127103/ca-justice-japar-dimaampao-known-muslim-jurist-appointed-supreme-court</ref>

Judicial Career

Regional Trial Court (2000–2004)

Dimaampao entered the judiciary in 2000 when he was appointed Presiding Judge of Branch 208 of the Regional Trial Court of Mandaluyong City.<ref name="sc_profile" /> Trial court work is where law meets life, and his four years there grounded him in the practical realities of docket management, courtroom proceedings, and the human stakes of litigation. He rose to become the Executive Judge of the Mandaluyong RTC, a role that added significant administrative responsibility to the judicial function, requiring oversight of other judges and coordination of the court's operations.<ref name="sc_profile" />

Court of Appeals (2004–2021)

In March 2004, President Gloria Macapagal-Arroyo appointed Dimaampao as an Associate Justice of the Court of Appeals, making him the youngest magistrate in the appellate court at that time, at just 40 years old.<ref name="wikipedia" /> He succeeded Justice Alicia Austria-Martinez and began what would become a seventeen-year career at the country's second-highest court.<ref name="wikipedia" />

During his time at the CA, he eventually became Chairperson of the court's 3rd Division and served on key internal committees, including the Committee on Rules/Raffle and the Committee on Inventory and Audit of Caseload of Retiring Justices.<ref name="sc_profile" /> His decisions during this period are noted for their technical precision, particularly in tax cases, where his CPA background gave him an edge in reading complex financial structures that most other justices might have found opaque.<ref name="sc_profile" />

Judicial Service Timeline of Japar B. Dimaampao

Judicial Level	Specific Role	Duration	Key Focus Area
Regional Trial Court	Presiding/Executive Judge, Mandaluyong	2000–2004	Trial procedures, docket management
Court of Appeals	Associate Justice / Division Chairperson	2004–2021	Appellate review, Taxation, Commercial Law
Supreme Court	Associate Justice	2021–present	Constitutional law, Shari'ah integration

Supreme Court of the Philippines (2021–present)

His appointment as the 191st Associate Justice of the Supreme Court, filling the vacancy left by Justice Alexander Gesmundo who had been elevated to Chief Justice, came on July 2, 2021.<ref name="wikipedia" /> He took his oath of office on September 14, 2021, to widespread celebration across the Bangsamoro region.<ref

name="wikipedia" />

The JBC Marathon: Sixteen Applications and Counting

The most well-known chapter of Dimaampao's story is the one that almost didn't have a happy ending. He applied for a seat on the Supreme Court a total of sixteen times, and during the Duterte administration alone, he appeared on the JBC shortlist thirteen separate times without being chosen.<ref name="wikipedia" /> Within the legal community, this became known simply as the "JBC marathon," and it was a test of character as much as credentials.<ref name="mb_barmm">BARMM endorses Dimaampao as next SC justice. Manila Bulletin, October 27, 2019. https://mb.com.ph/2019/10/27/barmm-endorses-dimaampao-as-next-sc-justice/</ref>

Throughout that process, his supporters in the Bangsamoro Parliament and among Moro representatives in the House of Representatives campaigned actively for his appointment, calling it a fulfillment of long-overdue commitments to historical justice.<ref name="wikipedia" /> His own response to being repeatedly passed over was, by all accounts, remarkably composed.

When JBC members asked him why he kept coming back, he pointed to his faith:

> "God is with those who patiently persevere," and "God is the final disposer of affairs."<ref name="abs_cbn" />

He also told the JBC that he held onto the secular idea that "hope springs eternal," and that he trusted his time would come when the "fullness of time" allowed.<ref name="abs_cbn" /> That combination of spiritual conviction and professional steadiness made him a distinctive presence in JBC hearings, where candidates are often scrutinized primarily for political connections or institutional backing. Dimaampao maintained a consistently respectful stance toward the President's appointing power, stating that he honored the discretion of the executive branch while continuing to offer his services.<ref name="abs_cbn" />

Legal Scholarship and Published Works

Parallel to his judicial work, Dimaampao has built a serious reputation as a legal author and educator. His textbooks on tax law are used in some unexpected places: Harvard Law School and the Islamic Science University of Malaysia are among the institutions that reference his work.<ref name="centralbooks">Justice Japar B. Dimaampao, Centralbooks. https://central.com.ph/book-author/japar-b-dimaampao/</ref> That kind of reach isn't typical for Philippine legal authors, and it says something about the quality and clarity of his writing.

His published works include:

- *Basic Approach to Income Taxation* (Rex Book Store): A foundational text that bridges accounting principles and tax law for students and practitioners.<ref name="wikipedia" />
- *Tax Principles and Remedies* (Rex Book Store): A detailed guide to the administrative and judicial processes in tax disputes.<ref name="wikipedia" />
- *Bar Essentials in Commercial Law* (Central Books): A comprehensive Bar examination reference for commercial law subjects.<ref name="wikipedia" />
- *Bar Q&A for the Past 10 Years: Taxation Law* (Central Books): A study aid analyzing recurring Bar exam patterns in taxation.<ref name="wikipedia" />
- *Statutory and Judicial Quick Guide to Local Government, Real Property, and Taxation*: A specialized reference for sub-national fiscal policy and real property law.<ref name="centralbooks" />

As a classroom teacher, Dimaampao has taught at the University of the East, the University of Santo Tomas Faculty of Civil Law, San Beda University (both Mendiola and Alabang campuses), and the De La Salle University Tañada-Diokno School of Law.<ref name="sc_profile" /> His teaching style is known for making complex concepts genuinely accessible, without dumbing them down, a quality that also runs through his judicial writing.<ref name="philja_journal">Philippine Judicial Academy Journal, Vol. 16, Issue 41. https://philja.judiciary.gov.ph/files/journal/vol16issue41.pdf</ref>

At the Philippine Judicial Academy (PHILJA), he serves as a Professorial Lecturer II at the Department of Shari'ah and Islamic Jurisprudence, training judges and court personnel in Islamic law.<ref name="sc_profile" /> His contributions to the field of taxation were recognized in 2018 when he was named the **Metrobank Foundation Professorial Chairholder in Taxation Law** and the **Pedro Concepcion Professorial Chairholder for Commercial Law**.<ref name="sc_profile" />

Shari'ah Advocacy and Islamic Law Integration

Dimaampao is probably the most visible advocate for the Shari'ah justice system within the mainstream Philippine legal framework, and he's made it clear that his advocacy comes from principle, not just identity politics.

The Philippine Shari'ah courts were established by the 1977 Code of Muslim Personal Laws to govern the personal and family matters of Muslims, but the system has long remained incomplete without a dedicated appellate structure. When appeals from Shari'ah District Courts land in the secular Court of Appeals or the Supreme Court, the reviewing justices may lack the theological and linguistic expertise needed to interpret Shari'ah doctrines accurately.<ref name="sc_shariah">G.R. No. 211089, Maliga v. Tingao. SC E-Library. https://elibrary.judiciary.gov.ph/thebookshelf/showdocs/1/69172</ref> For Dimaampao, this is not a minor administrative gap; it's a structural injustice.

He has been a consistent advocate for the creation of a **Shari'ah Appellate Court** and for the formal integration of Shari'ah rules of procedure into the national judicial infrastructure.<ref name="bta_parliament" /> At the first National Shari'ah Summit, he made the case that integrating Shari'ah is not about separating Muslim Filipinos from the national system; it's about making the system genuinely whole:

> Integrating Shari'ah into the Philippine legal framework is not about division but about binding the nation's multicultural influences into a cohesive whole.<ref name="inquirer_shariah">SC embarks on effort to strengthen PH's shari'ah justice system. Inquirer.net. https://newsinfo.inquirer.net/1738719/sc-embarks-on-effort-to-strengthen-phs-shariah-justice-system</ref>

His practical contributions in this area include chairmanship of the 2020 Special Shari'ah Bar Examinations and service as Co-Vice Chairperson of the Technical Working Group on Shari'ah.<ref name="wikipedia" /> He has also pushed for the digitalization and modernization of Shari'ah court procedures, aligning them with the Supreme Court's broader technology agenda under the Strategic Plan for Judicial Innovations 2022–2027.<ref name="sc_shariah_indispensable">Justice Dimaampao: Shari'ah an Indispensable Component of the Philippine Legal Framework. Supreme Court of the Philippines. https://sc.judiciary.gov.ph/justice-dimaampao-shariah-an-indispensable-component-of-the-philippine-legal-framework/</ref>

Judicial Philosophy

Dimaampao's judicial philosophy centers on constitutional supremacy and a carefully defined version of judicial activism. In his JBC interviews, he stated plainly that he would be guided by the definition of judicial power under Article VIII, Section 1 of the 1987 Constitution, which he reads as authorizing the Court to check "grave abuse of

discretion" by the other branches, even when the issue might otherwise be considered political.<ref name="philstar" />

At the same time, he's not someone who believes courts should rewrite legislation from the bench. His opinions reflect what might be called a pragmatic originalism: a preference for faithful interpretation of the law as written, with reform properly left to the legislature.

He approaches institutional design through what he calls a "Black Swan" framework, borrowed from Nassim Nicholas Taleb's concept of rare, high-impact events. He has argued that courts and rules of procedure must be built to withstand crisis, not just routine business.<ref name="philja_journal" /> This view shapes his support for the Strategic Plan for Judicial Innovations 2022–2027, which prioritizes technological advancement and proactive access to justice.<ref name="sc_asean">Justice Dimaampao Discusses Access to Justice in the Philippines in ASEAN Forum on Victim-Sensitive Adjudication of Trafficking Cases. Supreme Court of the Philippines. https://sc.judiciary.gov.ph/justice-dimaampao-discusses-access-to-justice-in-the-philippines-in-asean-forum-on-victim-sensitive-adjudication-of-trafficking-cases/</ref>

His philosophy also draws on the Islamic principle of *Shura* (consultation), which he connects to modern ideas of open government and public participation. He has advocated for "Moral Governance" as a judicial framework, arguing that transparency and accountability are the foundations of public trust in legal institutions.<ref name="barmm_governance">BARMM Government signifies commitment to uphold open, good governance. BARMM Official Website. https://bangsamoro.gov.ph/news/latest-news/barmm-govt-signifies-commitment-to-uphold-open-good-governance/</ref>

Notable Supreme Court Opinions and Contributions

Taxation and Prescription: People v. Consebido (2025)

In *People v. Consebido* (G.R. No. 258563), Dimaampao filed a significant concurring and dissenting opinion addressing the prescriptive period for violations of the National Internal Revenue Code (NIRC).<ref name="lawphil_consebido">People v. Consebido, G.R. No. 258563. Lawphil.net. https://lawphil.net/judjuris/juri2025/apr2025/pdf/gr_258563_dimaampao.pdf</ref> The majority opinion sought to abandon long-standing doctrines and establish that the prescriptive period for tax fraud runs from the moment the violation is discovered. Dimaampao, drawing on his detailed knowledge of the NIRC's legislative history, cautioned against that approach. He argued for "obeisance to legislative intent," insisting that expanding or contracting prescriptive periods is the legislature's job, not the Court's.<ref name="lawphil_consebido" /> The opinion is a clear expression of his "pragmatic originalism" in action.

PhilHealth Funds Transfer Case (2025)

When the Supreme Court struck down the transfer of PHP 60 billion in excess PhilHealth funds to the National Treasury as unconstitutional, Dimaampao agreed with the result but took a narrower view of the remedy.<ref name="sc_philhealth">Press Briefer, December 5, 2025. Supreme Court of the Philippines. https://sc.judiciary.gov.ph/press-briefer-december-05-2025/</ref> While the Court unanimously ordered the return of the funds and voided the specific budget provision, Dimaampao argued against the wholesale invalidation of the underlying Department of Finance circular (DOF Circular No. 003-2024). His position was that the circular could be reconciled with the Universal Health Care Act and the Sin Tax Laws, and that the Court's corrective power should be focused precisely on the illegal transfer, not on dismantling the broader regulatory framework.<ref name="sc_philhealth" />

Filipino Sign Language Rules

Dimaampao chaired the Technical Working Group that drafted the *Rules on Filipino Sign Language (FSL) Interpreting in the Judiciary*, a set of rules designed to guarantee full participation by d/Deaf Filipinos in court proceedings.<ref name="sc_pressbriefing">Press Briefer, October 29, 2025. Supreme Court of the Philippines. https://sc.judiciary.gov.ph/press-briefer-october-29-2025/</ref> The process involved collaboration with the Komisyon sa Wikang Filipino, Deaf organizations, and trial court representatives. The resulting FSL Rules align the Philippine judiciary with the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities and mark a concrete step toward an inclusive justice system.<ref name="sc_pressbriefing" />

Notable Supreme Court Positions (2021–2025)

Case / Subject	Document ID	Dimaampao's Stance
PhilHealth Funds Transfer	G.R. Nos. 274778, et al.	Opposed wholesale invalidation of the DOF circular; sought reconciliation with the Universal Health Care Act
Tax Prescription Rules	G.R. No. 258563	Dissented against judicial legislation of prescriptive periods
Filipino Sign Language Rules	A.M. No. 21-12-04-SC	Chairperson of the TWG; drafted the rules for judicial FSL integration
Plunder and Graft Absorption	G.R. Nos. 228374–84	Supported ruling that graft acts are not automatically absorbed by plunder
Shari'ah Rules of Procedure	(Multiple)	Advocate for formal integration of the Shari'ah Bar

Cultural and Symbolic Significance

For the Bangsamoro people, Dimaampao's place on the Supreme Court carries weight that goes far beyond his individual career. He is widely regarded as a symbol of the community's long-standing aspiration to be represented in the highest institutions of the republic, an aspiration that the 1996 Final Peace Agreement and the Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro had, in principle, called for.<ref name="bta_parliament" />

Chief Minister Ahod "Al Haj Murad" Ebrahim of the BARMM specifically noted that Dimaampao's presence on the bench helps the region's transition by ensuring that the Bangsamoro Organic Law is interpreted with a genuine understanding of its historical and cultural context, not just its literal provisions.<ref name="barmm_official" /> The Bangsamoro Transition Authority (BTA) has repeatedly pointed to him as a model for the next generation of Bangsamoro lawyers and as a sign that the national government is finally delivering on inclusive governance.<ref name="barmm_official" />

For the Maranao people specifically, his appointment is a point of distinct pride. He is the first Maranao and only the second Bangsamoro to ever sit on the High Court, and his presence there means that the legal traditions, the lived realities, and the historical claims of the Maranao are now, for the first time, represented at the level of national jurisprudence.<ref name="bangsamoro_parliament_pr">Republic of the Philippines, Bangsamoro Parliament Press Release 516. https://parliament.bangsamoro.gov.ph/wp-content/uploads/2022/03/PR516.pdf</ref>

Personal Life and Values

Dimaampao is married to Maria Gina Perez Villapañe, and their partnership is often cited by those who know him as the steady foundation that allowed him to endure the long years of repeated JBC applications without bitterness.<ref name="sc_profile" />

Those who have worked with him describe his character in terms that rarely appear in judicial profiles: humility, rigorous intellectual discipline, and a genuine enjoyment of the classroom. His advice to Bar examinees captures how he sees the relationship between faith and professional life:

> "Trust God, simplify your answers, and pray for guidance."<ref name="youtube_bar">Justice Japar B. Dimaampao, Message to 2022 Bar Examinees. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Kh45-bcFFGw</ref>

He has been described as a "devoted educator," and by all accounts that isn't just a polite formality. His classroom work spans nearly four decades and multiple law schools, and the consistency of that commitment alongside an active judicial career says something about what he considers important.

Recognition and Awards

- **2018 Metrobank Foundation Professorial Chairholder in Taxation Law** (San Beda University Mendiola) <ref name="sc_profile" />
- **Pedro Concepcion Professorial Chairholder for Commercial Law**<ref name="sc_profile" />
- **Juris Doctor** (honoris causa conferred), University of the East, 2024<ref name="ue_jd" />
- Recognized by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament and the BARMM government as the region's foremost representative in the national judiciary<ref name="barmm_official" />
- Participant, 2025 WIPO Intellectual Property Judges Forum, Geneva<ref name="wipo_forum">2025 WIPO Intellectual Property Judges Forum Program. https://www.wipo.int/edocs/mdocs/mdocs/en/wipo_ip_ju_ge_25/wipo_ip_ju_ge_25_program.pdf</ref>

Professional and Institutional Affiliations

Professional and Institutional Affiliations

Category	Specific Association	Role
Academic	University of the East, UST, San Beda, DLSU	Faculty Member / Alumnus
Judicial Body	Supreme Court of the Philippines	191st Associate Justice
Fiscal Authority	2018 Metrobank Foundation Chair	Professorial Chair in Taxation Law
Islamic Law	2020 Shari'ah Bar Examinations	Chairperson
Administrative	Sub-Committee on Special Commercial Courts	Vice-Chairperson
Reform	Strategic Plan for Judicial Innovations (SPJI)	Expert / Contributor
Executive (Historical)	Department of Justice	First Muslim Senior State Prosecutor

Legacy

Dimaampao's service on the Supreme Court is expected to run until 2033, and the legacy taking shape around him centers on three things: the entrenchment of Shari'ah justice as a proper and integrated part of the Philippine legal system, the use of taxation expertise to clarify some of the country's most contested fiscal doctrines, and a quietly persistent proof that merit and faith can carry someone all the way to the top of a national institution, even when the door is closed thirteen times first.

His work on the FSL Rules, his push for Shari'ah appellate structures, and his classroom commitment all point toward the same belief: that a justice system is only as good as its capacity to actually reach the people it's supposed to serve. That belief, expressed through decades of teaching, writing, and deciding, is probably his most durable contribution.

Further Reading

- Dimaampao, Japar B. *Basic Approach to Income Taxation*. Rex Book Store.
- Dimaampao, Japar B. *Tax Principles and Remedies*. Rex Book Store.
- Dimaampao, Japar B. *Bar Essentials in Commercial Law*. Central Books.
- Dimaampao, Japar B. *Bar Q&A for the Past 10 Years: Taxation Law*. Central Books.
- Dimaampao, Japar B. *Statutory and Judicial Quick Guide to Local Government, Real Property, and Taxation*.
- Philippine Judicial Academy Journal, Vol. 16, Issue 41 (includes Dimaampao lecture on judicial resilience and the Black Swan framework).
- UP CIDS Discussion Paper 2020-01. "The Triumvirate Quandaries of Muslims in the Philippines." https://cids.up.edu.ph/

See Also

- Supreme Court of the Philippines
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Shari'ah court (Philippines)
- Code of Muslim Personal Laws (Philippines)
- Abdulwahid Bidin
- Bangsamoro Organic Law
- Judicial and Bar Council (Philippines)
- Philippine Judicial Academy
- University of the East College of Law
- Marawi City
- Maranao people

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